



Graphics Cards

Brace your kidneys!

The graphics card shortage that was meant to get rectified late last year never happened. And GPU manufacturers as well as OEMs couldn't be any happier. The only folks who are truly sad are us gamers. We really can't catch a break with all the constant fluctuations. In the midst of all this, GPU manufacturers have barely put out any entry-level cards. This year we saw the launch of the RX 6000 series of graphics cards from AMD bringing hardware-accelerated ray-tracing capabilities but more importantly, we saw the launch of several new scaling technologies to help existing graphics cards perform better. First there was AMD's FidelityFX Super Resolution technology which helps even 3-5 year old cards get additional FPS in current games, and it even works on NVIDIA cards. Not to be left behind, NVIDIA also brought out NVIDIA Image Scaling to compete with FSR. Even better was the release of DLSS 2.3 which significantly improves visual fidelity in games with RTX enabled. So there's was a lot of action on the software front and hopefully, there will be a lot of new releases when CES rolls in this coming January. Onto the winners.

Winner: ZOTAC GAMING GeForce RTX 3080 Ti AMP Extreme

It was a tough competition between the AMD RX 6900 XT and the NVIDIA RTX 3080 Ti cards. The former is the absolute best from AMD and the latter is practically a replacement for the RTX 3090 which is NVIDIA's best card but was launched a year ago. Between the two, the Radeon RX 6900 XT performs better than the RTX 3080 Ti in a lot of video games



AMD Radeon RX 6900 XT
Price: ₹1,43,999



ASUS TUF Gaming GeForce RTX 3060 Ti OC Edition
Price: ₹89,500

in 1080p and 1440p gaming. However, when it comes to 2160p or 4K gaming, then the RTX 3080 Ti either equals or sometimes performs better than the RX 6900 XT in quite a few video games. And remember, these flagship cards are marketed at 4K gaming graphics cards. When we factor in ray-tracing performance, any ambiguity of deciding the winner goes right out of the window. The NVIDIA cards perform better in synthetic benchmarks as well as in video games such as Far Cry 6, Cyberpunk 2077, Resident Evil 8 Village and Watch Dogs Legion. And thus propels the RTX 3080 Ti to become this year's Zero1 Award Winner.

1st Runner Up: AMD Radeon RX 6900 XT

Like we already mentioned, the Radeon RX 6900 XT and NVIDIA RTX 3080 Ti are very competitive at 4K resolution without ray-tracing involved. However, at 1080p and 1440p, the RX 6900 XT easily retains a lead over the RTX 3080 Ti and should the game support AMD's FidelityFX Super Resolution technology, then you could potentially get a lot higher frame rates without any discernible loss in visual fidelity. Moreover, considering the fact that you can get an RX 6900 XT for about ₹40K cheaper than an RTX 3080 Ti, it's really a no brainer of a card. Also, the ray tracing performance isn't bad. If the RTX 3080 Ti ends up giving 100 FPS in a video game with ray-tracing at 4K, then the RX 6900 XT will give you about 90. Both cards give you more than enough frame rates to experience ray-tracing in current gen video games with ease.

2nd Runner Up: ASUS TUF Gaming GeForce RTX 3060 Ti OC Edition

Never in the history of the Zero1 Awards would we have ever given the Best Buy mention to a graphics card that costs nearly a lakh. And the other surprise is that an RTX 3060 Ti is getting the Best Buy mention over the RTX 3060 because of how closely they're priced even though their performance is miles apart. The RTX 3060 Ti is a great mid-range graphics card that allows for 1080p as well as some 1440p gaming with ray-tracing turned on. The ASUS TUF Gaming GeForce RTX 3060 Ti OC Edition gives you that additional value because of the factory overclock and that makes this year's Best Buy, an even sweeter deal.

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ZOTAC GAMING GeForce RTX 3080 Ti AMP Extreme
Price: ₹1,76,999